6.8.2 Major New born Disorders

It can be divided into congenital anomalies and acquired problems.

6.8.2.1 Congenital Anomalies

It can be defined as structural or functional anomalies, for example metabolic disorders. That occur during intra uterine life and can be identified in prenatal period or birth, or some times may only be detected in infancy such as hearing defects.

Birth defects

Physical — Developmental

Most Common Types

a. Congenital Heart Disease: An abnormality in the heart that develops before birth ex. Ventricular septal defect.

b. Down Syndrome: A genetic chromosome 21 disorder causing developmental symptoms.

c. Cleft Lip and Palate: Opening or splits in the roof of the mouth and lip.

d. Spina Bifida: Failure in the development of spinal cord.

e. Club Foot: Foot is twisted out of shape or position.

f. Phenyl Ketonuria: A birth defect that causes amino acid called phenylalanine to build up in the body.

g. Edward's Syndrome : A condition that causes severe developmental delays due to chromosome disorder. It also called as trisomy 18.

1983 the average life expectancy of a person with down's syndrome was a mere 25 years old today its 60.

6.8.2.2 Acquired Disorders

These are not inherited or present at birth, but developing after birth. Some of the disorders are

1. Low birth weight
2. Malnutrition
3. Infections and parasites

1. Low birth weight: A (LBW) low birth weight infant is an infant with a birth weight of less than 2.5 kg regardless of gestational age.

a. Preterm babies: Babies born before 37 weeks of gestation. If given good neonatal care these babies can catch up growth by 2-3 years of age.

b. Small for date: (SFD) These babies may be born at term or preterm. They weigh less than 10% of the gestational age. SFD have a high risk of dying not only during the neonatal period, but during their infancy most of them become victims of protein energy malnutrition and infections.

Risk factors

1. Malnutrition
2. Infection

Treatment

1. Increase food intake
2. Control infections
3. Early detection and treatment of medical disorders.

2. Malnutrition: Scarcity of suitable food, lack of purchasing power of the family, traditional beliefs, taboos, leads to an insufficient balanced diet resulting in malnutrition.

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